KARIM ELSARHA

Inventory Planning & Control Manager | Procurement | SAP MM

Cairo, Egypt | +20 102 027 0053 | karimelsarha@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/karim-mohamed-abdallah | karimelsarha.github.io/Portfolio

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Inventory Planning & Control Manager with 18 years of experience across procurement, inventory management and cost accounting, including 10 years in procurement and inventory at the Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE). Head a 25-person department running warehouses across 9 port and industrial-zone sites, with zero stock variances in two consecutive annual inventory counts. Led the SAP MM workstream through go-live in January 2026, owned the master data and trained all warehouse users. Co-managed EGP 50.3M in contract awards in 2022 at about 21% below estimated cost, and handled international procurement including letters of credit. Skilled in demand forecasting, Min-Max and ABC planning, and building inventory reporting with Python, SQL and Power BI.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE), Cairo, Egypt

Inventory Planning & Control Manager | *Jan 2025 - Present*

Head of the Inventory Planning & Control Department, overseeing warehouses across 9 sites: HQs in the New Administrative Capital and Ain Sokhna; Sokhna, Adabiya, El Tor, East Port Said, West Port Said and El Arish ports; and Qantara West Industrial Zone & Technology Valley.

- Selected by executive management to lead the department, managing 25 staff (1 department manager, 2 section heads, 8 inventory specialists and accountants, and 14 storekeepers) and conducting their performance appraisals.
- Plan inventory and replenishment for 400+ SKUs using ABC analysis, Min-Max levels, reorder points and consumption-based forecasts by site and category, configured in SAP MM and the department's inventory database.
- Oversaw the FY2024/25 excess-stock drawdown, cutting total on-hand units by 23% (124.6K to 96.4K) with no disruption to issuing or operations. Cut office-supply replenishment by 95% year over year, and covered a full year of copy-paper demand from existing stock with no new purchases.
- Achieved zero variance between physical and book balances in 2 consecutive annual physical inventories, with quarterly cycle counts and stock reconciliation with Finance.
- Led the SAP MM workstream (procurement and inventory) through a 4-year ERP implementation that went live in January 2026. Owned all MM master data, and directed the team that extracted and cleansed it; reviewed and validated it before handover to the implementation partner.
- Trained all 25 warehouse staff hands-on on SAP MM, from receipt to issue, and defined role-based user authorizations for each user.
- Built and maintain the department's inventory database and reporting tools using Python, SQL and Power BI, and rolled out barcode tracking at 4 of 9 sites, with the remaining sites underway.
- Digitized custody tracking for 1,700 employees, replacing paper records. Retrieving an employee's full custody history now takes under a minute instead of several days.
- Authored SCZONE's new Warehouse Management Regulation, covering receiving, issuing, returns, custody and stock security; it is currently in legal review ahead of approval.
- Run an annual cycle to identify and sell slow-moving and scrap inventory (about 50 slow-moving and 1,000 scrap line items per cycle). Work daily with Procurement on requisitions, specifications and delivery schedules to keep replenishment aligned with demand.

Procurement Section Head | *May 2016 - Jan 2025*

- Headed a procurement section that grew from 3 to 8 staff (one of two section heads in the Contracts Department), covering the full sourcing cycle (RFQ, tender, evaluation, award, contract) for goods, works and services across SCZONE's ports and industrial zones.
- Co-managed EGP 50.3M in contract awards in 2022 (EGP 31.6M by tender and EGP 18.7M by direct purchase). Awards came in 16% below estimated cost on tenders and 29% below on direct purchases, saving about EGP 13.7M (21%) overall.
- Supervised every stage of the government procurement cycle for direct purchases, tenders and public auctions: budget confirmation, tender documents and advertising, committee formation, bid opening and evaluation, award, contract drafting and supplier performance follow-up. In 2022 this covered 15 competitive procedures (9 public tenders, 3 limited tenders, 2 public auctions and 1 limited negotiation), 115 direct orders, 79 tender packages and 18 contracts.
- Ran vendor registration and qualification for a supplier base of 1,500+ vendors (265 added in 2022 alone), and evaluated bids on price, technical compliance, delivery terms and service quality.

- Led procurement for a new Vessel Traffic System (VTS) tower at Sokhna Port, starting with no prior specifications or in-house expertise. Brought in the Suez Canal Authority at no added cost to help write specifications and tender documents to international standards. Awarded to the lowest bidder with current-generation technology, and took the project from planning to final acceptance in 8 months.
- Renewed maintenance contracts for 300+ copiers across 6 ports and 4 industrial zones. Rejected the supplier's 10% price increase using market benchmarking and negotiation, and renewed at unchanged prices with full maintenance and spare-parts coverage.
- Handled international procurement for port systems: a gas pressure-reduction station (Pietro Fiorentini, Italy), tugboat spare parts (MAPSO, Switzerland) and navigation equipment (Vissim, Norway), including letters of credit and customs clearance.
- Sourced high-value goods and works, including fire-fighting network upgrades, explosive-detection systems, maintenance of a 22 kV ring main unit at East Port Said and 147 PCs for government entities.
- Co-authored SCZONE's Procurement & Contracts Regulations as part of a 5-member team. The regulations were formally approved and remain in effect.

Red Sea Ports Authority (RSPA), Suez, Egypt

Budgeting & Cost Accountant | *Jun 2008 - May 2016*

- Prepared the annual budget and multi-year financial forecasts, consolidating inputs from department heads.
- Monitored budget execution through the fiscal year, analyzed variances and recommended corrective actions.
- Analyzed operational cost data to support management decisions and cost control.
- Assessed the cost impact of price changes in goods and services on port operations.

KEY SKILLS

Inventory Planning & Control: Inventory Planning, Demand Forecasting, Replenishment Planning, Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP), Min-Max, Reorder Point, ABC Analysis, Cycle Counting, Physical Inventory, Stock Reconciliation, Slow-Moving & Obsolete Inventory, Scrap Disposal, S&OP Support (demand & inventory inputs)

Warehouse Operations: Multi-Site Warehouse Management, Receiving & Issuing, Custody & Asset Tracking, Barcode Tracking, Warehouse Policies & Controls

Procurement & Contracts: Government Procurement Cycle, Public Tenders & Auctions, Direct Procurement, Strategic Sourcing, Tendering (RFQ / RFP / ITB), Bid Evaluation, Supplier Qualification, Contract Management, Negotiation, Cost Savings, International Procurement, Letters of Credit, Customs Clearance, Procure-to-Pay (P2P), FIDIC & USAID Procurement Rules (working knowledge)

ERP & Data: SAP MM, ERP Implementation, Master Data Management, End-User Training, Role-Based Authorization, Power BI, SQL, Python, Advanced Excel, KPI Reporting

Finance: Budgeting, Cost Analysis, Variance Analysis

Leadership: Team Leadership, Performance Appraisal, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Policy Development

Languages: Arabic (Native), English (Professional)

EDUCATION

- Master of Science in Supply Chain Management, Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport (AASTMT), Egypt | Expected Aug 2027
- Bachelor of Commerce (Accounting), Suez University, Egypt
- Associate Degree in Management Information Systems, Suez Higher Institute for Management Information Systems, Egypt

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute (PMI) | Expected Dec 2026
- Certified in Planning and Inventory Management (CPIM), Association for Supply Chain Management (ASCM) | Expected Feb 2027

TRAINING

- Industrial Transformation & Economic Development Seminar, Academy for International Business Officials (AIBO), China Ministry of Commerce, Beijing | Jul-Aug 2024. Member of the official Egyptian delegation.
- Behavioral Barriers in Leadership, National Center for Training and Leadership (NCTL), Egypt | 2022
- Anti-Corruption Training, National Anti-Corruption Academy, Egypt | 2022